in a different realm, round whose name legend has already gathered

— Lenin.

The Flowering of Arab Culture and Contacts with India

Having rapidly conquered large parts of Asia, Africa, and a bit of Europe, the Arabs turned their minds to conquests in other fields. The empire was being consolidated, many new countries had come within their ken and they were eager to find out about this world and its ways. The intellectual curiosity, the adventures in rationalist speculation, the spirit of scientific inquiry among the Arabs of the eighth and ninth centuries are very striking.

Normally, in the early days of a religion based on fixed concepts and beliefs, faith is dominant and variations are not approved or encouraged. That faith had carried the Arabs far and that trium-

**A kind of Shamanism or Shamaism still lingers in Arctic Siberia, Mongolia, and in Ta-*

nna Tuva in Soviet Central Asia. This appears to be based entirely on a belief in spirits and has apparently no connection whatever with Buddhism. Tet it may have been influenced

long ago by some degraded forms of Buddhism which were gradually submerged in local-pri-

mitive superstitions. Tibet, which is patently a Buddhist country, has developed its own